Dannar Zharkyn

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EDUCATION

BOSTON UNIVERSITY – M.S. in Systems Engineering **Expected December 2026**
Boston, MA, USA
- Distinguished Systems Engineering Fellowship
- Innovate@BU Summer Accelerator Finalist
- 2nd & 3rd Place, Student Wellbeing Competition

L.N. GUMILYOV EURASIAN NATIONAL UNIVERSITY – M.Eng. in Computer Engineering and Software **June 2025**
Astana, Kazakhstan | GPA: 3.88/4.0 | Graduated with Honors
- Thesis: Development of a software system for monitoring urban population movement using multi-agent models
- 1st Place, 18th International Scientific Conference "Gylym Zhane Bilim 2024"

L.N. GUMILYOV EURASIAN NATIONAL UNIVERSITY – B.S. in Computer Engineering and Software **June 2023**
Astana, Kazakhstan | GPA: 3.59/4.0 | Graduated with Honors
- Thesis: Development of a control system for a robot assistant
- 2nd Place, First International Contest of Researchers "Bilim Zhane Bolashak"

EXPERIENCE, PROJECTS AND LEADERSHIP

Boston University Student Wellbeing – Software Engineer **June 2026 - Present**
Boston, MA
- Lead the development and ongoing improvement of Terrier Pursuit, a web-based scavenger hunt platform used by 400+ students across BU orientation and community events
- Translate stakeholder requirements and user feedback into product improvements with university staff and the development team
- Co-designed Terrier Fit and Common Ground, project concepts promoting student wellbeing, earning 2nd and 3rd Place in the Student Wellbeing Competition

Somni Systems – Co-Founder, Product Development **Summer 2026**
Innovate@BU Summer Accelerator Finalist | Boston, MA
- Co-developed an adjustable pillow for neck discomfort, translating user needs into product requirements and a functional prototype
- Conducted 50+ customer interviews to identify recurring pain points and guide product design, prototyping, and positioning

Boston University – Grader / Teaching Assistant **Sep 2026 - Present**
EK 500 Probability with Statistical Applications | Boston, MA
- Evaluate student assignments and provide academic support in probability and statistical applications

Systems Engineering Graduate Student Association – Member **Sep 2025 - Present**
Boston University | Boston, MA
- Coordinate academic and social events for Systems Engineering graduate students, contributing to planning, logistics, and event execution

Boston University – Graduate Researcher **Sep 2025 - June 2026**
Systems Engineering | Boston, MA
- Conducted theoretical research on Fisher information, CBFs, and CLFs, applying these concepts through mathematical analysis and simulations to explore optimization, safety, and control problems

"ZERDELI" Educational Center – Mathematics & Logic Teacher **Sep 2023 - Apr 2025**
Astana, Kazakhstan
- Mentored and instructed 90+ schoolchildren in mathematics and logic, preparing students for competitive school admissions

L.N. Gumilyov Eurasian National University – Teaching Intern **Sep - Dec 2024**
Astana, Kazakhstan
- Taught practical lessons on the no-code platform AppMaster.io to bachelor's students in the "Tools of Program Development" course

SKILLS

Programming & Data: C++, Python, Power BI
Embedded Systems: Arduino, Microcontrollers
Web & Product: React, Next.js, TypeScript, Miro, Trello
AI & Developer Tools: AI-assisted development, prompt engineering, Codex, GitHub, Vercel, Supabase
Languages: Kazakh (native), Russian (fluent), English (fluent), Chinese (elementary)